

What Is Health?

Health is more than not being sick — it is physical, mental and social well-being together.

Health is complete well-being

According to the **World Health Organization (WHO)**, health is a **state of complete physical, mental and social well-being, and not merely the absence of disease**.

Aspect	Means
Physical	Body works well — good diet, exercise, sleep, hygiene.
Mental	A positive, calm mind — managing stress and worry.
Social	Good relationships — friends, family, fitting in with others.

How to stay healthy

- Eat a **balanced diet** (fruits, vegetables, whole grains); avoid too much oil/sugar and junk food.
- Stay **physically active**; limit screen time; get enough **sleep**.
- Practise **yoga / pranayama**, keep clean, and say **NO** to tobacco, alcohol and drugs.
- Keep the **environment clean** — clean air and water; the **AQI** tells us how clean the air is.

Signs vs Symptoms

Symptom	Sign
What the patient feels (pain, tiredness, dizziness)	What can be seen or measured (fever, rash, swelling)

Ayurveda link: true health is balance of body, mind and surroundings — through *dinacharya* (daily routine), *ritucharya* (seasonal routine), good food, sleep and a calm mind.

Where students lose marks

Trap 1 — Health is NOT just "no disease". The WHO definition needs all three: physical, mental and social well-being.

Trap 2 — Sign vs symptom. A *symptom* is felt by the patient (pain); a *sign* can be seen/measured (fever). Don't swap them.

Slip — mental and social health matter too: someone who eats well but is lonely is not fully healthy.

Model answers — write them like this

Example A. Define health as per the WHO.

Step 1: Recall the three aspects: physical, mental, social.

∴ A state of complete physical, mental and social well-being, not merely the absence of disease.

Example B. Classify as sign or symptom: (i) headache (ii) a temperature of 102°F.

Step 1: Headache is felt by the person → symptom.

Step 2: 102°F can be measured → sign.

∴ (i) symptom (ii) sign.

[Ready to practise?](#) → [Open the worksheet](#)